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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1982-1985

Coverage Date: 1982-1985

Place Coverage

!Koi!kom, Central Kalahari Game Reserve, Botswana

Section Title(S)

1. Visiting Occasions at Camp P (Visitor Sample) • 4. Longitudinal Transition in Visiting Relations • SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC TRANSACTIONS

Second, some of the people who belonged to the same group as the present residents in '82, tended to frequently visit Camp P in '84. However, other previous co-members rarely or never visited Camp P. This alienating tendency is especially conspicuous among women. More than a half the number of women (6/11) who had been previous co-members never or rarely visited Camp P in '84. Evident signs of social conflict were observed between the residents of Camp P and individuals who have become estranged from them.

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Third, the subject group has a number of 'stable partners', i.e., those who frequently visited the subject group in both years. Six men who are included in this category reside in 5 different camps, while most of the 8 women included in this category reside in only one camp, i.e., Camp Kj. This point again exemplifies that the range of social intercourse among women is conspicuously smaller than that of men.

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SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC TRANSACTIONS

This section deals with various kinds of transactions which are realized through the visiting activity. By the term 'transaction', I mean any interaction between visitor and resident which are enacted for some practical purpose.

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The first type of transaction which can be most easily identified by the observer is an economic one, such as giving and receiving goods, serving and consuming food or drinks, aid for labor, and barter.

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The second type of transaction refers to several kinds of physical contact, such as grooming, play-fighting, and flirting; behaviors which are supposed to display or reinforce the affiliative bond between the participants. Round smoking might be an intermediate of the above 2 types, because it not only gives rise to pleasure among the participants, but also involves giving and consuming goods, i.e., tobacco leaves.

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1. Visiting Occasions at Camp P (Visitor Sample)

Table 5 shows 22 cases of the Visitor Sample, and the frequencies of 8 kinds of transactions observed in each case. The following description is primarily based on the data presented in Table 5, but anecdotal observations will also be referred to.

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(1) Round smoking

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Round smoking is the most frequent form of transaction between visitors and residents, occurring in 72.7 percent (16/22) of the Visitor Sample. It occurred about once per hour (0.85 times/hour). In principle, all adults present in the scene participate in round smoking. It is examined when each of the 39 visitors, whom I could observe continuously from their arrival to their leaving the scene, participated in the first occasion of round smoking. All of the first occasions of round smoking occurred within 50 minutes of the visitors' appearance. Fifty percent of these occasions occurred within only 15 minutes. The average duration of vititor's stay is 14.9 minutes before the first occasion of round smoking, and 41.9 minutes after that.

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The temptation to smoke tobacco is overwhelming for most of the San. They inhale to be intoxicated, with strong pleasure, even though they often frown or cough painfully. Thus the experience of such 'communal pleasure' might be useful for stabilizing ■185

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Table 5. Social and economic transactions between visitor and resident observed in Camp P (Visitor Samples).

The frequencies of transaction are represented by the numbers of observation unit (5 min each). Figures in parentheses indicate the cases where visitor supplied residents with goods or food. Figures in squared parentheses indicate the number of samples in which each kind of transaction occurred at least once. Smoke: round smoking; Donate: giving and receiving goods; Feed: serving food; Water: serving water; Groom: grooming (picking-off lice); Help: aid for labor; Joke: joking behavior; Child: seeking the contact with children.

No.	Visitor		Resident		Dur. (min)	Types of transaction							
	M	F	M	F		Smoke	Donate	Feed	Water	Groom	Help	Joke	Child
V1	6		2	2	70	1	3						
V2	1	1	1		75								4
V3	1	1	1	2	40		(2)	1					
V4	1		2	2	40	1							1
V5	2	2		2	115	1 (1)		2	1	12	1	1	1
V6	2	1	4	5	110	1 (2)			1			1	
V7	2	3	3	5	105	(2)	2		1	3			
V8	1		2	1	65	1							
V9	9		8		55	1							
V10	1	4	4		205	1 (2)		2			2		
V11	1	5	5	3	125	2	(1)	2	1	4			
V12	3	5	3	4	125	1 (1)		1 (1)		6		1	
V13	1	2	3		85	2 (1)	(1)	2 (1)			8		
V14	1		3		85			1					
V15	3	3	1	5	190	2		2	1	13		1	
V16	1		6		55	2	2						
V17		4		3	35	1				3			
V18	6		5	1	130	(1)	1	1					
V19	2		2		85		1		1				
V20	2		7		45	1						1	
V21	2		5	1	80						3		1
V22	3		6		60								3
Total	51	31	73	36	1980	18 (10) [16]	9 (4) [8]	14 (2) [9]	6 [6]	41 [6]	14 [4]	5 [5]	10 [5]

186 or activating the scene. In this sense round smoking may be functioning as the ‘ceremony’ which welcomes the visitor into the scene and establishes a peaceful coalition between visitor and resident.

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Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street
New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries: hraf@yale.edu
Issues and Bugs: hraf-support@yale.edu



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